Lesson 29

DIVINE HEALING PART 4 – HEALING THE SOUL

Aim: To share the biblical concept and blessing of Divine Healing.

Introduction:

There are two processes of healing for the body: natural and supernatural (divine). Medical doctors know they cannot heal. They only assist the "natural" healing powers already in the body.

But Jesus is greater than other physicians. By His supernatural power, sick bodies can also be healed. The divine power for such healing comes directly from God.

I. TWO SOURCES OF HEALING.

The same two sources for healing also apply to the soul. It is said that time heals. This natural healing that occurs with the passage of time does help us outgrow some of the inner hurts which were such problems during our younger years.

1. NATURAL

We find out in time that not everybody is stronger, smarter and better looking than we are. Most of us learn to relate to others and succeed in our fields of work. We gain the respect of our families, friends and fellow workers.

As we grow in years, we face grief, sorrow and losses with understanding. Even those with mental illness often recover by themselves over a period of time. It seems the soul has natural healing powers, as does the body.

Some people however, do not outgrow their problem of early life. They carry their painful scars on into adulthood. All of us probably have some hurts we recall from the past which affect our present attitudes and actions.

For some, however, the carryover is so great, they can hardly function in a normal way. Many such people have suffered mental or emotional breakdowns. When wounds are deep, the results may be lifelong.

Psychologists and psychiatrists are doctors who treat mental and emotional disorders. They seek, through medicine and counsel to assist the natural healing powers of the soul.

However, just as there are physical diseases which cannot be cured, so there are sicknesses of the soul which cannot be

helped in natural ways. To "restore" such a soul would take a "miracle"– a supernatural healing.

I know of young people who have "burned" their brains and damaged their souls on drugs. At one time they were bright, healthy youngsters with much to look forward to in life.

Now they are broken in spirit, mind and body. Is there any hope, or is it too late? Only a miracle can meet such a need. Praise God, there is hope.

Our Lord is the mighty God of miracles and mercy!

2. SUPERNATURAL

Let us look at these gracious words from the prophet Isaiah:

> *"Share what you have with the hungry. Meet the needs of those who are afflicted who suffer the inner pain of being rejected. Then your light shall rise in the darkness, and your night will be as the noonday"* - Isaiah 58:10

The pain of being rejected (or put away– divorced) can be healed only by love and acceptance. God desires to reach out to the "afflicted" through you and me– through our hearts and hands.

A. David Experienced Healing. David spoke for us all in his hour of inner pain when he cried out: *"Lord, have mercy on me. Heal my soul, for I have sinned against you"*–Psalm 41:4

David knew personally about this healing love of God, or he could never have written the Twenty-third Psalm: "The Lord is my shepherd… He has restored [healed] my soul."

Later on, the Psalmist speaks of God's grace in these beautiful words: *"The Lord heals the brokenhearted and binds up their wounds– curing their pains and their sorrows… Great is our Lord and mighty in power. His understanding is without limit. He lifts up the humble– those who have been put down…"* Psalm 147:3,5,6

B. Jesus Brought Healing Then. There is special passage in the gospels which I have seen in a new light. I should like to share it with you, for it speaks of the nature of our Lord's healing ministry:

"Jesus went about all of Galilee preaching the gospel of the kingdom… and he healed every kind of disease and sickness. The report of his healing power spread throughout Syria. Therefore, they also brought to him people with many different diseases and torments. Others

suffered from demon possession, epilepsy, and paralysis. And he healed the all"– Matthew 4:23, 24

It is of interest to note the that the Scriptures say that Jesus healed "every kind" of sickness and disease (vs 23). This included spiritual, mental, emotional and physical problems. Verse 24 names some of the diseases related to each part of man's total being:

1. Spiritual sickness– demon possession;

2. Emotional sickness– torments;

3. Physical sickness– paralysis.

C. God Heals Today. Jesus went about making men and women completely whole. Wherever sin had broken into– spirit, soul or body– Jesus forgave, cleansed and brought the healing power of God's love.

I think of my good friend, Costa Deir. When God found him in the depths of sin, he was hopeless case. Alcohol had damaged his brain, liver, heart and digestive system. Satan had robbed him of his friends and family. The devil had destroyed his body, and was after his soul.

He was spiritually, mentally and physically sick– and about to die. Then he met the greatest

physician in the entire world– the Lord Jesus Christ.

And what did Jesus do? He made him completely whole– a new creature– in spirit, soul and body. Hallelujah! No wonder he now wants to tell the whole world about the healing power of God's love.

II. FIVE STEPS TO HEALING THE SOUL

Yes, God wants us well. But what is the process by which "inner healing" can come to our lives? I believe there are five important steps we can prayerfully take in faith.

The first three of the five steps for healing of the injured soul can be found in these words of hope and comfort by Jesus:

- "Come to me, all you who are weary and under a heavy load, and I will give you rest.
- "Take my yoke upon you, and
- "Learn of me, for I am meek and lowly. Then you will find rest [restoration] for your souls"-Matt 11:28

1. Come To Jesus

The first step for inner healing (or healing for the soul) is this: Come to Jesus! Jesus invites us to come to Him.

If we go anywhere else, or look to any other source, we will be let down and disappointed. To whom do you turn in your time of need? Jesus says: "Come unto me…"

Yes, Jesus waits with open arms and bids us to come to Him. There is also welcome for the lost sinner.

As said before, we need to be forgiven and set free from the heavy load of guilt and condemnation. This is where "inner healing" begins. We all must come to Jesus as our Savior. Without this first step, we can never take the second. We must repent if we want to be restored.

2. Take His Yoke

The yoke of Christ refers to His governance (control) over our lives. He must not only be our Savior, but also our Lord and Master.

The devil wants to deceive us with a lie. He wants us to believe that we will lose our "freedom" when we give our life to the Lord. He will never tell us that his yoke of sin becomes heavier and more painful the longer we carry it.. In the end, we will fall beneath its weight. Only God's grace can truly set us free.

Many Christians suffer under the weight of a yoke of their own making. It is the weight of a self-willed life. They have confessed Christ as their Savior. They want to

go to Heaven when they die. However, they also want their won way in many areas of their life here on earth.

God sometimes lets us have our way to teach us a lesson. We soon will find that it becomes a very injurious road. To walk in the "flesh" includes many painful falls. Each one leaves a scar on our souls, as we have already seen.

Clearly, this kind of inner pain can be healed only as we turn to Jesus and confess Him as the Lord of our life. To our joy we will find that His yoke is easy and light– as feathers are to a bird.

Total submission of our lives to Jesus means a total healing of our lives by Jesus. Moreover, it is the only way to true spiritual freedom.

When our faith, hope and plans for the future are linked with the Lord, our inner strength will be renewed and restored. Then we can freely soar without tiring– as on the wings of an eagle! - Isaiah 40:30, 31

3. Learn of Him

When Jesus is the Lord of our lives, we become His disciples. A disciple is one who watches, listens and learns from his teacher. What is it that w can learn from Jesus about the healing of our soul (inner healing)?

We might wonder: Was Jesus ever in circumstances (places) where His soul was injured and wounded? If He was, how did He respond to such pain? How was His soul restored?

a. He suffered. Jesus is the perfect pattern or model for our life. If we can discover how_He– in His humanity– met such problems, we can find the solution for ours. Let us turn to God's Word for our answers. The scene of Jesus' wounding begins in the Garden of Gethsemane:

> *"And he took with him Peter, James and John. Soon he began to show great grief and distress of mind– and was deeply depressed. "Then he said to them, 'My soul is very sad, and my heart is almost breaking with sorrow. I feel as if I am about to die. Please stay with me and watch and pray'"*– Matt 2:37, 38

The awful hours that followed on Calvary were described by the prophet Isaiah. He speaks of our Lord's body being beaten, that our bodies might be made whole: *"By his stripes we are healed"*–Isaiah 53:5

I believe He also suffered in His soul– that our souls might be healed. Listen to these further

words from the prophet's pen: *"He shall see the travail and suffering of his soul, and be satisfied… for he has poured out his soul unto death…"* Isaiah 53:11, 12

As said above, this terrible prophecy was fulfilled during the events of Christ's crucifixion. Not only did He suffer in body, but His soul was hurt as well. He was forsaken by His disciples and rejected by the Jews.

They mocked Him, pulled His beard and slapped His face. He was laughed at, spat upon and brought to a place of open shame before the people. The religious leaders of the day loudly jeered, while He suffered in pain.

What more could have been done to make His agony of soul any worse? Just one thing– to be forsaken by His heavenly Father! There could be no greater hurt to a human heart. Yet it had to be. It was the price He had to pay for the penalty of our sin.

Not only was the heart of His Son broken, but so was the heart of the Father in Heaven. *"The sinless soul of God's Son became sin– for he took our sin– that we might become right and holy before God"*-2 Cor 5:21

How terrible must have been this cry from the lips of Jesus as it echoed from earth to Heaven: *"My God, my*

God, why have you forsaken me?"–Mark 15:34. Truly, when the sword was thrust into the side of Jesus, it was more that just blood and water which poured forth:

"For he poured out his soul unto death…" Isaiah 53:12. Yes, the Lord Jesus offered His soul, that we might have healing for ours. Without a doubt, He experienced every hurt known to the soul of man.

b. He Forgave. The stress and strain on His soul during those awful hours must have been terrible. How did He keep His inner being in victory? What was it that protected His soul form destruction?

I believe the answer can be found in His response to His "tormentors"– the cruel leaders and soldiers at the foot of the cross: *"Father, forgive them, for they don't know what they are doing."* - Luke 23:34

What was it that protected and restored His soul? It was forgiveness! Truly, this is what we must learn from Jesus– how to forgive. It is the main key to inner healing.

c. We Must Forgive. Do you remember the story Jesus told about the man who had been forgiven a large debt by his master? Yet he himself would not forgive someone who owed him a much smaller debt.

His master was very angry when he learned about his unforgiving spirit. Therefore, he had him thrown into prison to be "tormented" by his jailers. Jesus replied the story in a very personal way: "So shall my Father do to you, if in your heart you refuse to forgive your brothers" (see Matthew 18:30-35)

What did Jesus mean by this? If we fail to forgive another, a root of resentment can begin to grow in our souls. In time, it will bear very bitter fruit. If we hold on to "hard or hurt feelings" towards someone, our souls will suffer.

In time, the pain will bring torment to all parts of our life– a life that becomes a hell on earth. Forgiveness is the key that unlocks the cell in that hell.

The Psalmist was speaking of Jesus when he said: *"You will not leave my soul in hell, or let your Holy One see decay and destruction"*– Psalm 16:10

Our souls can actually rot and decay in the Hell of unforgiveness. Hell couldn't hold the Lord Jesus, because He already held the key of forgiveness in His nail-scarred hand.

If you are suffering from the soul sickness of resentment, look to Jesus for the grace of forgiveness. It is a sure, fast remedy that can bring healing to your soul.

Speak out these words: "Father, forgive them- and forgive me– right now for Jesus' sake and in His Name, I pray. Amen." It shall be so!

4. Come as Little Children

After forgiving those who have hurt and injured us, we are ready for our next step toward inner healing. We are to come to Jesus as little children.

Our support from Scripture comes from Mark's gospel. Parents were bringing their little children to Jesus to be touched and blessed. The disciples were upset this action because it was robbing them of their time with Jesus.

Therefore, they reproved the parents and tried to send the little children away. Jesus was very displeased with their action and spoke these words to the disciples:

"Let the little children come to me, for the kingdom of God belongs to such as they. Don't send them away. Indeed, whoever does not receive the kingdom of God as a little child, shall not enter it at all"–Mark 10:14, 15

There is healing power, for the whole person in the Kingdom of God. Jesus showed that throughout His earthly ministry. However, to receive that healing power we must come as little children.

a. Early Memories Need Healing.

Many of the scars on our soul came from events in our early years as children. To these were added other injuries which we received as we grew up into adulthood.

I believed that becoming as a little child includes going back in our memories to our early years. What we are, and how we feel and think today, is a product of all of our past years added together.

Many of us have shadows from the past that darken our present-day lives. They can be traced to painful soul-injuries that occurred in years gone by. They have so damaged our mind and emotions, it is difficult to fully enter into our new life in Christ.

b. Holy Spirit Brings Healing. However, we now have a new Spirit within, which can bring the healing power of Jesus to those places of inner hurt.

With the help of the Holy Spirit, picture yourself in your mind as a little child with Jesus.

See yourself walking back through memory lane with the Lord. You don't have to be afraid to face anything, any place or anyone when Jesus is by your side. He doesn't want to hurt you, but to heal you from painful events that occurred in the past.

He will show you why you feel and act as you do when faced with certain situations.

We often have reflex feelings when we face something which reminds us of a hurtful or shameful part of the past. Sometimes we are not directly aware of the cause, but the emotional response is still there. We feel the same way each time.

The Lord wants to reach the roots of those painful reflexes. He desires to heal those memories with His love and understanding. Sometimes we recall the people who caused the wound in our soul. It could be a parent or other family member. Teachers and other authority figures sometimes abuse their right to rule over the lives of others.

It helps to understand that many times such people are sick in their own souls They too have been hurt in the past. So they use the power of their position to build up their own low sense of self-esteem.

In such cases, the Lord assures us of His love for us, and the special place we have in God's family. Then He reveals to us how much He wants to bring His love and forgiveness to everyone.

To be touched with that kind of love brings healing to our hearts. We are able to receive His forgiveness and be

set free from feelings of resentment or self-pity. Moreover, that love enables us to forgive and release others to God's grace and mercy.

d. Forgiveness Brings Healing

1. The Story of a Young Wife and Mother. I recall a young wife and mother in one of our World MAP Summer Conferences. She was driven by a wandering, gypsy spirit. At times, she would suddenly leave her husband and children and drive the family automobile miles from home.

Once, she had gone over a thousand miles before she was found and place in the ward of a local hospital. Finally, it was arranged for her to come to one of our meetings for prayer.

The Lord gave one of our team leaders a Word of Knowledge (revelation knowledge from the Holy Spirit) into the cause of her behavior. She had lived through a series of events in her girlhood which had seriously damaged her soul.

a. She Suffered. She had been born in Europe during World War II. Before the age of six, she had been physically and emotionally abused by both her

mother and father. Later, the starving parents abandoned her to take care of herself.

The war was a fearful period of time I her life. She lived through many bombing raids, not knowing whether she would live or die. She searched through garbage cans for food, and slept wherever she found some form of shelter. She finally joined a gypsy group and went with them as they wandered from place to place. The gypsy "spirit" took hold of her.

b. She Forgave. In the course of time, she came to America, found the Lord, and was married. Still, she was tormented by bad dreams, and driven by these sudden and strange desires to wander like a gypsy without reason or notice. It took a revelation from the Lord to uncover the cause of her soul-injury.

After prayer, counseling and ongoing support, she was able to forgive those who had abused her. Over period of time, the hurt in her heart was healed. God restored here soul and removed the pain from her tragic past. She became a nurse, ministering to the sick and suffering. Praise the Lord!

2. Lessons From the Life of Joseph. As we have seen, the role forgiveness is most important in receiving inner healing. A beautiful example of inner healing and

forgiveness is found in the Old Testament story of Joseph (see Genesis 37-46)

a. He suffered. You recall that he was given special favor and attention by his father, Jacob. As a boy, he was told by God in a dream that one day he would be a great ruler. His brothers were very jealous, and finally sold him as a slave into Egypt. The wife of his master failed in an attempt to lead him into sexual sin.

In her anger, she lied about his conduct, and had Potiphar, her husband, put Joseph in a dungeon.

Joseph began as a boy with the promise of a bright future. He ended up as a hopeless man in a dark prison. The Scripture says he was put in chains of iron: *"and the iron entered into his soul"* - Psalm 105:18

Betrayed, sold into slavery, falsely accused, forgotten in a prison, he was tried by the Word of the Lord. In the natural, he had every reason to be angry, bitter, resentful and even destroy himself by self-pity and despair. But he didn't.

Such situations will either make us "bitter" or "better." It depends on how we respond. The choice is ours. How did Joseph respond?

b. He Forgave. We know the rest of the story. Joseph was given important duties even while in prison. After thirteen years in prison, he was the only person in Egypt who could interpret Pharaoh's dream. As a result, he was placed by Pharaoh in a position of great authority and power. He became a ruler over all of Egypt.

God then brought his brothers back to him. What did he do? Rise up in anger? Destroy them in a fit of rage fired by years of resentment? No, he fed them and forgave them!

What brought forth such a noble response on the part of Joseph? I don't believe Joseph's action was hasty or by chance. It wasn't something that just happened because it seemed like a "good idea" at the time. It was an action born out of his character like that.

When Joseph saw his brothers, he had been in Egypt for some twenty-three years. He was a lad of seventeen when he arrived. That's plenty of time to become "bitter" or "better.

c. God Meant it for Good. I believe that Joseph held on to God's word and dream for his life. That was his hope. He had a divine destiny. Therefore, all things would finally work together for that good purpose. That

revelation kept him faithful and forgiving. You recall his words of divine wisdom to his brothers:

"Don't be afraid, for I am not in God's place as a judge. You meant to harm and hurt me, but God meant it for good. His purpose was to bring life to many people. So don’t be afraid, I will take care of you and your children.' In this way Joseph comforted them, and spoke kindly to their hearts" Gen 50:19-21

1. Joseph Trusted God. There is yet another truth about inner healing that we can learn from Joseph's life. After his rise to power in Egypt, he was given Asenath, the daughter of Potiphera, to be his wife. You will note that the name of his wife's father is very similar both in meaning and sound– to that of his former master, Potiphar.

a. God Healed His Memories. Any leftover hurt or resentment in Joseph's heart concerning Potiphar could easily have become a great problem. Just the sight of his father-in-law– or even the mention of his name– could have brought to Joseph's mind the painful years of his unfair punishment in prison. How many people suffer form this kind of "carry-over" from the past?

In God's grace, Joseph had been healed from all of the cruel and unfair pain of his past. This is clearly seen in the names of his first two sons, Manasseh and Ephraim. –Gen 41:51, 52

Manasseh means "making to forget" Joseph explains the choice of this name with these wonderful words: "For God has made me forget all the pain, toil and trouble of my youth– and my father's household" (vs51smf) God healed the memory of Joseph.

b. God Made Him Fruitful. Ephraim– the name of his second son– means "fruitful" Joseph adds these thoughts form his heart: "For God has caused me to be fruitful in the land of my pain and affliction." (vs52)

God has not only removed the pain from Joseph's memories; He did something else. He actually took the evil events in Joseph's life and turned them into great good– for Joseph and for God! God's eternal purpose was being worked out in time through Joseph's life. Nothing was lost or wasted. God make you fruitful in your land of pain and affliction. Allow Him in to heal you.

5. Commit Your Soul to God

God wants not only to heal our past hurts, but also to give us a bright hope for the future. We can trust Him to protect us from the kinds of inner injury which would damage our souls in the days to come.

The ready grace of His forgiveness can quickly put out the fires of anger, resentment, jealousy, fear and self-pity– before they can hurt us or harm others. Our soul can be at peace, and we can rejoice in His great love for us. In this we can find a true sense of self-worth. Like Joseph, we too have an eternal destiny– in Christ Jesus.

Perhaps, dear reader, your heart has been greatly moved by a hope for healing deep within your own soul. Accept this as the gentle work of the Holy Spirit preparing you for the release you so deeply desire.

a. Jesus Will Reveal. You may have tried before, on your won, to search out things from the past. But because it only led to deeper depression, you set it all aside. This time, try coming to Jesus– and let Him do the searching of your soul. He is wise, loving and very gentle. He can bring to your mind the parts, places and persons of past which need His healing touch. Again, we say Jesus wants to restore your soul and make you whole. Do not fear.

b. Jesus Will Heal. A member of our ministry team, Dr. Robert Frost (who left this life to walk with Jesus in 1992), tells this story:

"I speak this words from personal experience. I once tried to uncover the hurts of my past in My own strength and wisdom. It only made matters worse.

"I finally came to the Lord and simply said: 'I am going to trust You, Holy Spirit, to reveal to

me what I need to know. Do it in Your way, and in Your time.'

"Three days later, the Lord brought something to my mind that I had long forgotten. I saw myself as a little boy in the midst of a very sad situation. I had been rejected, and put aside in a most unkind and unloving way.

"I saw myself under a dark stairway at school with tears running down my face. I was looking to God for help, because I had been hurt and wounded within.

"In faith, I brought the Lord Jesus right into that part of my past. I asked Him to heal that painful memory. I pictured Jesus in my mind coming in love to that little boy. I saw Jesus put His arm around me as His little brother and heal my pain. In His strong arms I felt safe, secure, and most of all– loved.

"That inner healing has given me a great love for others who have deep scars in their soul. That is why I can say with

great feeling– and with great faith: Come to Jesus just as if you are a little child. Take His yoke of love upon you, and learn of Him. Let Him bring forgiveness and healing to your heart even now."

CONCLUSION

This biblical prayer can help you:

"Intimately examine me, O God, and know my innermost emotions: [soul]; investigate and test me as metal that is being refined, and know my thoughts, memories and opinions;

"And see if there be any mental pain sorrow or painful toil in me, as I have walked the course of my life; and govern, guide and lead me in my journey and manner of living, always and without end"–Ps 139, 24 lit amp

If the Lord shows you "any mental pain, sorrow or painful toil," bring it to Him . Let Him heal your soul. Jesus promised:

"Take my yoke upon you, and learn of me; for I am meek and lowly in heart: and ye shall find rest[oration] unto your souls"–Matthew 11:29